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# Moscow

For other places with the same name, see [Moscow \(disambiguation\)](#).

Since its founding in 1147, **Moscow** ([Russian](#): Москва, *Moskva*) has been at the crossroads of history as the capital of empires and a frequent target for invaders. As the capital of the [Russian Empire](#), the Soviet Union, and, today, the Russian Federation, it has played a central role in the development of the largest country in the world. For many, the sight of the Kremlin complex in the centre of the city is still loaded with symbolism and history.

Today, Moscow is a thriving, exuberant capital city that overflows with life, culture and sometimes traffic. A sprawling metropolis, the northernmost and coldest megacity on the planet, and the most populous city entirely within Europe, Moscow is also known for its many museums, Soviet-era monoliths as well as post-Soviet kitsch.

## Districts

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### Central Moscow districts



#### **Central Moscow**

Just north of the bend in the Moscow River. Includes the Moscow Kremlin, Red Square, St Basil's Cathedral, and the GUM department store.



#### **Moscow Central-North** (Krasnoselsky South, Meshchansky South & Tverskoy South raions)

North from the Kremlin, east from Tverskaya Street, north from Pokrova Street, the area within the Boulevard Ring. Home to the famous TsUM department store, as well as the Bolshoi Theatre, one of the world's premier opera and ballet venues.



#### **Moscow Central-South** (Yakimanka North & Zamoskvorechye raions)

Bordered by the Garden Ring and on north the Moskva River



#### **Moscow Central-West** (Arbat, Khamovniki North, Presnensky East, Tverskoy South raions)

North from the Moskva River, west from Tverskaya Street, the area within the Boulevard Ring.



#### **Moscow Central-East** (Basmanny West, Tagansky North raions)

North from the Moskva River, south from Pokrova Street, the area within the Boulevard Ring.

### Outlying districts

### **Moscow Outskirts**

The outskirts of the city include areas between Moscow's Garden Ring and the Moscow Ring Road (MKAD). Also includes the Moscow International Business Center (MIBC), also known as Moscow-City, with its modern skyscrapers, a symbol of Russia's transition to capitalism in the 1990s.

### **Zelenograd and New Moscow**

Consists of Zelenograd (Зеленоград) and New Moscow, consisting of Novomoskovsky (Новомосковский) & Troitsky (Троицкий) Administrative Okrugs, in the southwest.

## **Understand**

Moscow is the financial and political centre of Russia and the countries formerly comprising the Soviet Union. It has a population of around 13 million and an area of 2,511 square kilometres (970 sq mi) after an expansion in 2012. Moscow is the second most populous city in



Map of Moscow

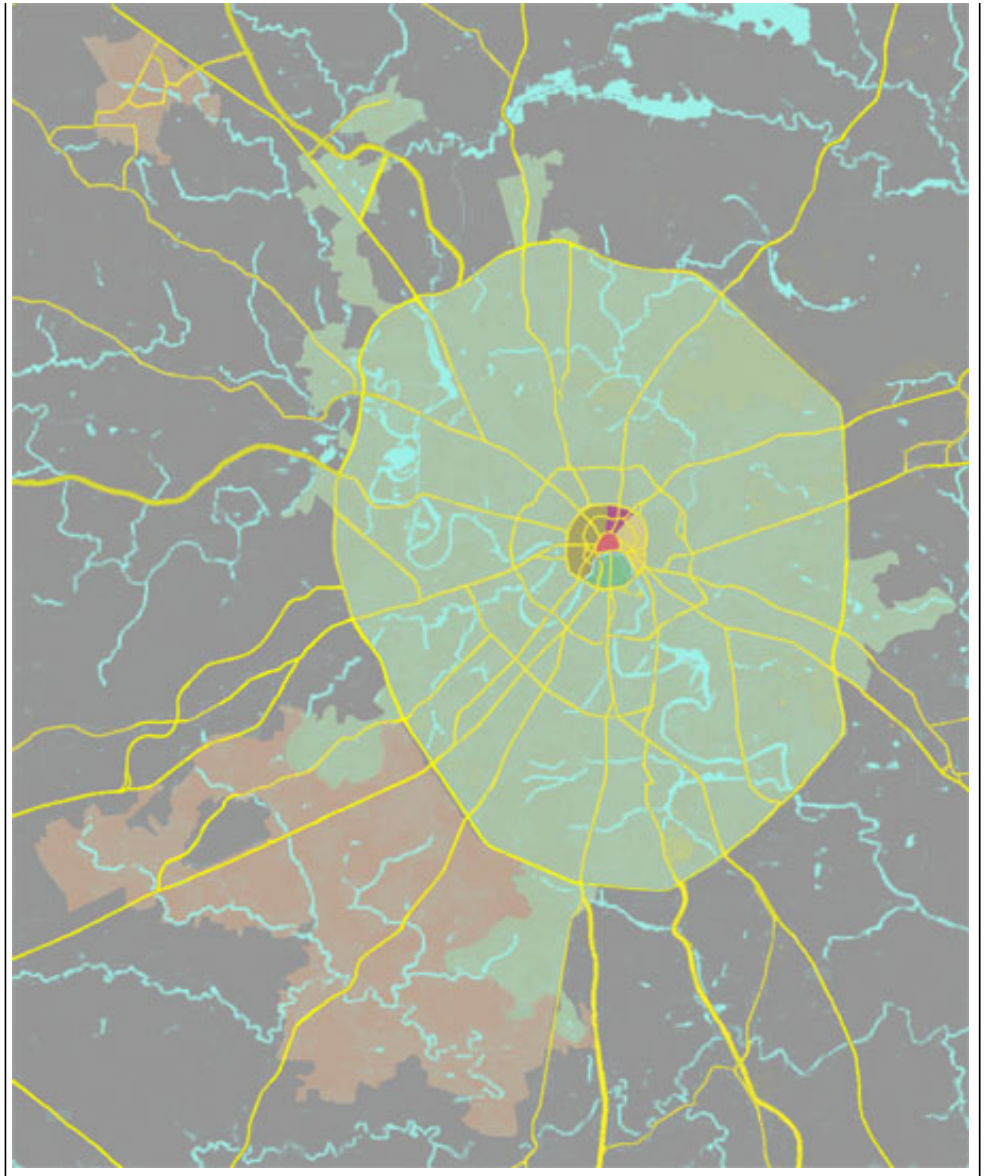
Europe, after Istanbul, and has the most populous metropolitan area in Europe, with some 21 million residents, comprising roughly one-seventh of the population of Russia. Moscow is in the UTC+3 time zone; there is no daylight saving time.

Many years since the break up of the Soviet Union, the economy has improved, and the modern era has brought upon a wide variety of construction projects, modern architecture and newer transport systems. The Moscow Metro, in particular, is the longest and busiest subway system in Europe. The city also features Europe's largest concentration of skyscrapers.

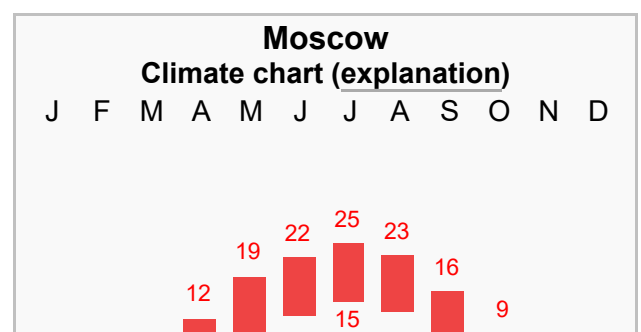
## Geography

Moscow is a large metropolis on the Moskva River, which bends its way through the city. The historical center is on the northern bank of the river. The other major waterway is the Yauza River, which flows into the Moskva east of the Kremlin.

Much of Moscow's geography is defined by the 3 'Ring Roads' that circle the city at various distances from the centre, roughly following the outline of the walls that used to surround Moscow. With Red Square and the Kremlin forming the very centre, the innermost ring road is the Boulevard Ring (*Bulvarnoye Koltso*), built in the 1820s where the 16th century walls used to be. It runs from the



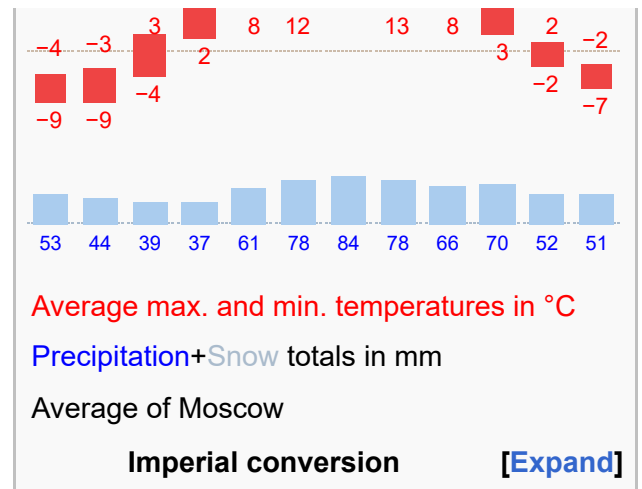
Red Square, painting by Fedor Alekseev, 1802



Christ the Savior Cathedral in south-west central Moscow, to the mouth of the Yauza in south-east central Moscow.

The next ring road, the Garden Ring (*Sadovoe Koltso*), derives its name from the fact that landowners near the road in Tsarist times were obligated to maintain gardens to make the road attractive. In Soviet times, the road was widened, and there are now no gardens there.

The Third Ring Road, completed in 2004, is not much use for tourists but is a heavily used motorway which absorbs a bit of Moscow's traffic. It roughly follows the outline of *Kamer-Kollezhsy val*, the customs boundary of Moscow in the 18th – early 20th century. The outer edge of Moscow is largely defined by the Moscow Ring Road (widely known by its abbreviation: MKAD-Moskovskaya kolcevaya avto doroga), a motorway which is 108 km (67 mi) long and encircles the entire city (similar to London's M25 and Paris' *Périphérique*).



## Climate

The climate of Moscow features warm summers and long, cold winters. Temperatures average below freezing for four months a year, between mid-November and mid to late March. Snow cover typically forms in late November or early December and melts in early April.

## Get in

See [Russia#Get in](#) for visa requirements to Russia.

## By plane

Moscow (**MOW** <sup>IATA</sup> for all airports) has four commercial passenger airports. The ones foreign visitors are most likely to arrive in are Sheremetyevo and Domodedovo.

**1 Sheremetyevo International Airport (SVO** <sup>IATA</sup>) (32 km (20 mi) northwest of the centre of Moscow, in the city of *Khimki*), ☎ +7 495 232-65-65. The main hub of Russian flag carrier **Aeroflot** (<https://www.aeroflot.com/>). There are multiple terminals - check your departure terminal before arriving at the airport.

To travel between the airport and the city:

- **Aeroexpress** (<https://aeroexpress.ru/en/>) is the only rail link to the airport. Trains operate between the airport and the *Belorussky Railway Terminal* (<https://transport.mos.ru/en/belorusky>) in the northwest section of the city centre. It also makes additional stops at Okruznaya, Savelovsky train station and Begovaya, where you can connect to the metro. Trains stop every 30 or 60 minutes from 05:00 to 00:30. The journey takes 50 minutes and costs 525 py6; tickets can be purchased online. Keep your paper or mobile ticket for the entire Aeroexpress journey. From the Belorussky Railway Terminal, the journey to the city center takes an additional 20 minutes by metro.



- **Bus #851** (57.pyb for a 90-minute transfer ticket purchased from the driver) and **Bus #949** (80.pyb) operate service between the terminals and the Rechnoy Vokzal Metro Station of Metro Line 2 (dark green). If taking a cheaper regular bus #851 or #817 (see below), the driver hands you a red card, which you then have to validate at the scanner, or you can purchase a ticket or Troika transport card at the ticket machine right at the bus stop in front of Terminal D arrival hall's exit. The majority of drivers don't speak any English, so don't depend on them for assistance. Once you get off the bus, continue by foot a few steps in the direction the bus was going in, and you'll see the metro station on your right in the first opening between the buildings. When returning to the airport, after leaving the Rechnoy Vokzal metro station, cross the street, go around the fence on the other side of the street and look for the bus under the orange-colored shopping center.
- **Bus #817** (61.pyb for a 90-minute transfer ticket purchased from the driver) or **Bus #948** (85.pyb) operate service between the terminals and the Planernaya metro station, at the northwest terminus of Metro Line 7 (purple). The journey by bus to the metro stations takes approximately 40 minutes and the journey to the city centre by metro takes an additional 40 minutes. Buses operate from approximately 05:30 to 00:45.
- **Bus #1195** (300.pyb one-way or 500.pyb round-trip), operated by Aeroexpress, connects terminals B and C with Khovrino metro station. Runs every 10 minutes between 6AM and 11:30PM, the journey lasts 20 minutes. Tickets can be bought online and in the bus.
- **Night Bus H1** (61.pyb) operates every 30 minutes between 00:30 and 05:30. The bus operates between the airport, city center (including Kitay-Gorod Transport Hub, where you can change to other night routes), and Yugo-Zapadnaya metro station.
- **Yandex Taxi** is the official taxi mobile app serving the airport. Prices to the city center are approximately 1,000.pyb.
- **Driving** past the toll bar should be avoided whenever possible as there are fees to do so. In addition to entry charge of 100.pyb/hour (rounded up to the next hour), after entering the toll bar, there is an extra charge from 100.pyb/hour to 300.pyb/hour, depending on the distance from the entrance and the comfort of parking—with an unofficial option of an unlimited-time stay for 300.pyb. However, there are unofficial parking lots near the airport, with daily rates starting at 200.pyb.

2 **Domodedovo International Airport (DME<sup>IATA</sup>)** (45 km (28 mi) southeast of the centre of Moscow), ☎ +7 495 933-66-66. It carries slightly more passengers than Sheremetyevo International Airport on an annual basis. The airport is the base of **S7 Airlines** (<https://www.s7.ru/>), and is also the preferred airport for most foreign airlines serving Moscow. Free WiFi is available throughout the airport. There are plenty of cafes, bars, restaurants, and shops in the airport.

To travel between the airport and the city:

- **Aeroexpress** (<https://aeroexpress.ru/en/>) trains operate between the airport and the Paveletsky Railway Terminal (<https://transport.mos.ru/en/paveletsky>) in the southeast section of the city centre. Trains depart every 30 minutes from 06:00 to 00:30. The journey takes 50 minutes and costs 525.pyb one-way; tickets can be purchased online.. Keep your paper or mobile ticket for the entire Aeroexpress journey. From the Paveletsky Railway Terminal, the journey to the city center takes an additional 20 minutes by metro.
- **Commuter trains** (<https://dme.ru/en/transport/train/>) are a cheaper method of traveling between the airport and the Paveletsky Railway Terminal (<https://transport.mos.ru/en/paveletsky>). The journey by commuter train takes 75 minutes and costs 120.pyb.
- **Bus #308** (<https://dme.ru/en/transport/bus/>) 100.pyb operates 24 hours/day between the airport and the Domodedovskaya Metro Station near the southeastern end of Metro Line 2

(dark green). There is plenty of space on the buses for luggage. The buses operate every 15 minutes, but every 40 minutes between 00:00 and 06:00. The trip takes 30 minutes. From the Domodedovskaya Metro Station, the journey to the center takes another 40 minutes by metro. When headed towards the airport, at Domodedovskaya Metro station, take the exit to the south (downtown side) turn right in the underpass, and follow it to the end, then take the stairs. There are crude stencilled signs of Bus 308 on the pillars to guide you. When you get to street level you will see a tall building across the street with blue words reading "Опexовo-Бopисовo Северное". The bus stop is next to this building.

- **Yandex Taxi** is the official taxi mobile app serving the airport. Prices to the city center are approximately RUB1,000.

**3 Vnukovo International Airport (<http://www.vnukovo.ru/eng/>) (VKO <sup>IATA</sup>)** (30 km (19 mi) southwest from the centre of Moscow), ☎ +7 495 937-55-55 (Head Office). Vnukovo International Airport serves approximately 12 million passengers per year.

To travel between the airport and the city:

- **Metro Line 8A (<https://www.vnukovo.ru/en/for-passengers/airport-directions/metro/>)** serves Vnukovo International Airport. The ride to the city center takes just over an hour.
- **Bus #911 and Night Bus #H11 (<https://www.vnukovo.ru/en/for-passengers/airport-directions/bus/>)** operate between the airport terminal and the Salaryevo Metro Station. The bus journey takes 35-40 minutes and costs 36 pyб if using Troyka transport card or 55 pyб if paid to the driver. From the metro stations, the journey to the city center takes an additional 40 minutes.
- **Yandex Taxi** is the official taxi mobile app serving the airport. Prices to the city center are approximately RUB1,000.

**4 Zhukovsky International Airport (<https://www.zia.aero/en/>) (ZIA <sup>IATA</sup>)** (40km southeast from the centre of Moscow). Opened in 2016 and has flights to/from Turkey, Sochi, and Central Asian countries.

To travel between the airport and the city (<https://zia.aero/en/how-to-get/by-public-transport/>):

- **Bus #441э (92 pyб)** operates between airport and Kotelniki metro station. The bus journey can take from 30 to 60 minutes, dependent on traffic jams.
- **Yandex Taxi** is the official taxi mobile app serving the airport. Prices to the city center are approximately RUB1,000.
- **Bus+Train** service, more information can be found on airport's official website (<http://zia.aero/en/how-to-get/by-public-transport/>)



Bus and train map (2019)

## By train

Moscow is a railway hub, with connections to all parts of Russia as well as Asia. Due to its hub status, Moscow's train stations are always crowded, and pickpocketing is an issue, however police patrols and CCTV cameras are abundant, and violent crime is unlikely. Train travel is the predominant mode of intercity transportation for the majority of Russians.

All long-distance trains are operated by Russian Railways (<https://eng.rzd.ru/>) and its subsidiaries, except for a few international trains with other operators. Tickets can be bought at stations or online (<https://eng.rzd.ru/>). There are usually ticket counters with English-speaking personnel - they may be marked as such, or the clerk may direct you to another counter if they can't cope with your English. See Russia#By train 2 for more details on travelling in Russia by train.



All aboard the Trans-Siberian!



## From Saint Petersburg

Saint Petersburg can be reached in 4 hours via the high-speed *Sapsan* trains. There are many daily departures each way, with some trains stopping at Tver, Vyshniy Volochek, Bologoye, and Okulovka. Fares vary and are cheaper if bought well in advance but usually start at 3,500 pyg for economy class, if purchased 2 months in advance or 7,500 pyg closer to the date of travel, if seats are even available. Trains almost always sells out.

There are also 13 overnight trains that travel between Moscow and Saint Petersburg and overnight trains are generally cheaper than the *Sapsan*. The most famous is the luxurious *Red Arrow* (Красная стрела), a train painted in bright red that departs Saint Petersburg daily at 23:55 while the song *Hymn to the Great City* plays on its loudspeakers.

## From Eastern Russia and Asia

See also: Trans-Siberian Railway

Tickets for the Trans-Siberian Railway sell out and it is cheapest to buy tickets at least 2 months in advance. Tickets can be bought online (<https://eng.rzd.ru/>)

The main line of the Trans-Siberian Railway runs between Moscow and Vladivostok, the biggest Russian city on the Pacific Coast. The *Rossiya* train leaves Moscow every other day at 13:20, while the slower but cheaper trains #44 or #100 leave every day around midnight. Major stops include Yekaterinburg (24-31 hours; 4,000 pyg for Platzkart class, 7,000 pyg for 2nd class), Omsk (35-48 hours), Novosibirsk (46-54 hours), Krasnoyarsk (54-66 hours), Irkutsk (68-81 hours; 9,000 pyg for Platzkart class, 11,000 pyg for 2nd class), Ulan Ude (75-89 hours), and Vladivostok (7 days; 14,000 pyg for Platzkart class, 25,000 pyg for 2nd class}}).

The other routes of the Trans-Siberian Railway, between Moscow and China, are more popular among tourists. There are two weekly trains to/from Beijing, the *Trans-Mongolian* (Train #4) via Ulaanbaatar and the *Trans-Manchurian* (Vostok/Train #20) via Manchuria. Both journeys take six nights but the ride via Mongolia offers more scenery.

## Train stations in Moscow

Moscow has 10 train stations, 9 of which are near metro stations close to the center of Moscow. Be sure to note the station from which your train is departing, which will be indicated on the ticket, or online (<https://eng.rzd.ru/>). Three stations (*Leningradsky*, *Yaroslavsky*, and *Kazansky*) are on one huge square, informally known as the "Three Stations' Square". Be prepared for enormous queues trying to enter or exit the Metro at peak times, as people are getting off or on the commuter trains.

| #  | Train Station                                                                                                   | Nearby Metro Station(s)   | Destinations of Interest to Tourists                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Belorussky (Белорусский вокзал) ( <a href="http://belorussky.dzvr.ru/">http://belorussky.dzvr.ru/</a> )         | Belorusskaya              | ( <b>Train 21/22</b> <a href="#">Smolensk</a> , <a href="#">Minsk</a> (10h), <a href="#">Kaliningrad</a> , <a href="#">Brest</a> , <a href="#">Uglich</a> , <a href="#">Kalyazin</a> , <a href="#">Rybinsk</a> , <a href="#">Aeroexpress</a> ( <a href="https://aeroexpress.ru/en/aero.html">https://aeroexpress.ru/en/aero.html</a> ) trains from/to <a href="#">Sheremetyevo International Airport</a> .                                                                                                                                                                |
| 2  | Kazansky (Казанский вокзал) ( <a href="http://kazansky.dzvr.ru/">http://kazansky.dzvr.ru/</a> )                 | Komsomolskaya             | <a href="#">Kazakhstan</a> , <a href="#">Ulyanovsk</a> , <a href="#">Uzbekistan</a> , <a href="#">Nizhny Novgorod</a> , <a href="#">Kazan</a> (11 hr, <a href="#">2500 pyb</a> 2nd class), <a href="#">Novorossiysk</a> , <a href="#">Orenburg</a> , <a href="#">Ossetia</a> , <a href="#">Altay</a> , <a href="#">Ufa</a> , <a href="#">Mordovia</a> , <a href="#">Penza</a> , <a href="#">Cheboksary</a> , <a href="#">Mari El</a> , <a href="#">Tumen</a> , <a href="#">Rostov-on-Don</a> , <a href="#">Adler</a> , <a href="#">Kolomna</a> , <a href="#">Ryazan</a> . |
| 3  | Kiyevsky (Киевский вокзал) ( <a href="http://kiyevsky.dzvr.ru/">http://kiyevsky.dzvr.ru/</a> )                  | Kiyevskaya                | <a href="#">Chişinău</a> , <a href="#">Kaluga</a> , <a href="#">Bryansk</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 4  | Kursky (Курский вокзал) ( <a href="http://kursky.dzvr.ru/">http://kursky.dzvr.ru/</a> )                         | Kurskaya, Chkalovskaya    | <a href="#">Vladimir</a> , <a href="#">Nizhny Novgorod</a> , <a href="#">Samara</a> , <a href="#">Tula</a> , <a href="#">Oryol</a> , <a href="#">Kursk</a> , <a href="#">Sochi</a> , <a href="#">Crimea</a> , the <a href="#">Caucasus</a> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 5  | Leningradsky (Ленинградский вокзал) ( <a href="http://leningradsky.dzvr.ru/">http://leningradsky.dzvr.ru/</a> ) | Komsomolskaya             | <a href="#">Pskov</a> , <a href="#">Saint Petersburg</a> , <a href="#">Tver</a> , <a href="#">Veliky Novgorod</a> , <a href="#">Petrozavodsk</a> , <a href="#">Murmansk</a> , <a href="#">Khimki</a> , <a href="#">Klin</a> , <a href="#">Tver</a> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 6  | Paveletsky (Павелецкий вокзал) ( <a href="http://paveletsky.dzvr.ru/">http://paveletsky.dzvr.ru/</a> )          | Paveletskaya              | <a href="#">Almaty</a> , <a href="#">Astrakhan</a> , <a href="#">Baku</a> , <a href="#">Donetsk</a> , <a href="#">Luhansk</a> , <a href="#">Saratov</a> , <a href="#">Tambov</a> , <a href="#">Volgograd</a> , <a href="#">Aeroexpress</a> ( <a href="https://aeroexpress.ru/en/aero.html">https://aeroexpress.ru/en/aero.html</a> ) trains from/to <a href="#">Domodedovo Airport</a> .                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 7  | Rizhsky (Рижский вокзал) ( <a href="http://rizhsky.dzvr.ru/">http://rizhsky.dzvr.ru/</a> )                      | Rizhskaya                 | <a href="#">Krasnogorsk</a> , <a href="#">Istra</a> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 8  | Savyolovsky (Савёловский вокзал) ( <a href="http://savelovsky.dzvr.ru/">http://savelovsky.dzvr.ru/</a> )        | Savyolovskaya             | Local destinations only, including <a href="#">Dmitrov</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 9  | Yaroslavsky (Ярославский вокзал) ( <a href="http://yaroslavsky.dzvr.ru/">http://yaroslavsky.dzvr.ru/</a> )      | Komsomolskaya             | <a href="#">Rostov Veliky</a> (express, twice a day, 3 hr, <a href="#">450 pyb</a> ), <a href="#">Sergiev Posad</a> (express, twice a day, 1 hr, <a href="#">300 pyb</a> ), <a href="#">Yaroslavl</a> (14 per day, 4 hr, <a href="#">500 pyb</a> ), <a href="#">Vologda</a> , <a href="#">Trans-Siberian Railway</a> trains to <a href="#">Siberia</a> , the <a href="#">Russian Far East</a> , <a href="#">Mongolia</a> , and <a href="#">China</a> .                                                                                                                    |
| 10 | Vostochny (Восточный вокзал) ( <a href="https://vostochny-i-vokzal.ru/">https://vostochny-i-vokzal.ru/</a> )    | Cherkizovskaya, Lokomotiv | <a href="#">Anapa</a> , <a href="#">Kursk</a> , <a href="#">Murmansk</a> , <a href="#">Nizhny Novgorod</a> , <a href="#">Novorossiysk</a> , <a href="#">Saint Petersburg</a> , <a href="#">Samara</a> , <a href="#">Sochi</a> , <a href="#">Volgograd</a> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

## By car

See also: [Driving in Russia](#)

Many entry points to Moscow over the Ring Road and into the city feature rotating roadblocks, where teams of traffic police may stop a vehicle, especially if it is not featuring Moscow plates. You may be stopped and questioned but you'll be allowed to proceed if you have all the proper documents.

## From Europe

Foreign cars, especially expensive cars, might attract unwelcome attention, and there is cumbersome paperwork involved to enter Russia by car. The direct way to drive from [Belarus](#) is along the [E30](#) road, although it requires having permission to enter Belarus. Russian Federal Highway [M10](#) is another popular route. Traffic on the [M10](#) is heavy.



## By bus

It is generally easier to travel via plane or train so most visitors to Moscow will not use the intercity buses.

**Ecolines (<https://ecolines.ru/>)** operates coach service between Moscow and various cities in Europe, crossing at the border with Latvia. Buses arrive to and depart from the Severnye Vorota Bus Station next to the Khovrino Metro Station on Metro Line 2 (green) in the northern section of Moscow. Destinations include Riga (20 hours, RUB14,000), Tallinn (28 hours, RUB14,000), Vilnius (22 hours, RUB14,000), Warsaw (31 hours, RUB18,000), Minsk (9 hours, RUB2,100), Amsterdam (51 hours, RUB30,000), Prague (48 hours, RUB24,000), and Berlin (38 hours, RUB24,000).

Many domestic intercity buses stop at the Moscow Intercity Bus Terminal (<https://mosoblvokzal.ru/>), next to the Shchelkovskaya Metro Station at the eastern terminus of Metro Line 3 (dark blue). Buses to the popular tourist destination of Suzdal operate from this station.

There are also several small bus stops and stations with buses to/from small towns that are not commonly visited by tourists.

- **5 Moscow Central (Schyolkovskiy) Bus Terminal aka Intercity bus station (<https://mosoblvokzaly.ru/>)** (Центральный Автовокзал, Московский междугородный автовокзал) (*Shelkovskaya Metro station (the last station of the (3) line, in northeast Moscow). Under highway overpass*), ☎ +7 499 748-8029. Daily 04:00-23:15. Intercity buses to Russian and some former Soviet Union cities depart from here. This is the only place in Moscow from which public transport is available directly to Suzdal.
- **6 Intercity buses Krasnogvardeiskaya** (*Krasnogvardeiskaya Metro station*). Southern way.
- **7 Regional buses**, Proezd Stratonavtov (пр. Стратонавтов), 9 (*Tushinskaya Metro station*), ☎ +7 495 491-8215. To west/northwest direction within the Moscow region, Volokolamsk, Zvenigorod, Ruza.
- **8 Intercity bus station Yuznye Vorota (<http://busterminal.ru>)** (Автостанция Южные Ворота). Southeastern direction toward Ryazan. Voskresensk, Yegoryevsk, Bronnitsy, Lukhovitsy.
- **9 Intercity bus station Kotelniki (<http://mostransavto.ru>)** (Автостанция Котельники) ((7) *Kotelniki Metro station*). Southeastern direction toward Ryazan. Voskresensk, Yegoryevsk, Bronnitsy, Lukhovitsy.
- **10 International bus station Severnye Vorota ([http://www.mosgortrans.ru/av/severnye\\_vorota/](http://www.mosgortrans.ru/av/severnye_vorota/))** (Автовокзал Северные Ворота) ((2) *Khovrino Metro station*). Northern direction toward St. Petersburg, northeastern toward Riga, Tartu, Pskov, western toward Mariampole, Smolensk.

## By boat

There is no scheduled passenger service to Moscow by boat; however, cruise ships do provide service to the Northern River Terminal, on the Moscow Canal near the Khimki Reservoir. The pier is not convenient to the city and it can take over 2 hours to reach the city centre by car.

A system of navigable channels and locks connects the Moskva River with the Volga River, which is further connected to the Baltic Sea, White Sea, the Azov, the Black Sea, and the Caspian Sea. In the Soviet times this allowed the official propaganda to refer to Moscow as "a port on the five seas".

## By bicycle

Moscow is the easternmost destination of the EuroVelo cycling routes. Eurovelo Route 2 (<http://www.eurovelo.com/en/eurovelos/eurovelo-2>), the Capitals Route, is a 5,500 km (3,400 mi) route starting in Galway, Ireland, passing through Dublin, London, Berlin, Warsaw and Minsk before terminating in Moscow.

## Get around

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### By public transport

Yandex Maps is the best mobile app for planning journeys on public transport.

The metro is comprehensive, boasts some great architecture, and is relatively cheap. City buses, trolleybuses, trams and metro operated under "Moskovskii transport" franchise by different operators but common fare system.

The cheapest way to use the public transportation system is to purchase a plastic Troika (<https://transport.mos.ru/en/troika>) re-loadable debit card. The card costs 50.00pyb and can be redeemed for cash at the end of your trip. You can "top up" your balance at any metro station. For each trip taken, 57.00pyb will be deducted from your card. If you make a change from the metro to a ground transport or other way around within the next 90 minutes of your trip, the next shoulder will cost you only 22.00pyb. The Troika card also can also be used via a mobile app. Troika cards can also be used to pay an Aeroexpress tickets, Velobike bike sharing, the entrance to the Moscow Zoo, the Tretyakov Gallery and the Lunarium Museum of the Moscow Planetarium. Alternatively, red paper cards can be purchased at metro stations at a cost of 70.00pyb per trip or 340.00pyb for 24-hours.

Also there is unlimited tickets for 1, 3, 30, 90 or 365 days which is very useful, if you plan to use public transport a lot.

### By metro

The Metro is open from 05:30-01:00. Station entrances are closed at 01:00, and at this time the last trains depart from all of the termini stations. After 01:00, many locals will enter the train station using the exits, which are still open. Service on the ring line runs until 01:30, although entrances are closed at 01:00. The down escalators are also shut off at 01:00.

There is signage in the Metro stations in English and the Latin alphabet, but these signs are not everywhere. Each train carriage has a map in Latin script and there is one near the entrance to each station. Note the direction of the train before you alight. A map of the metro system in both Cyrillic and Latin letters is available online ([http://news.metro.ru/sc\\_lat.html](http://news.metro.ru/sc_lat.html)).

All trains in the system have free WiFi onboard, but you will need to have a Russian phone number to get the authorization code to access the WiFi. Some of the older train cars are not climate controlled.

2 or 3 stations may be connected as transfer points but will each have a different name. There are 2 stations called **Smolenskaya** and 2 stations called **Arbatskaya**, but the station pairs are not connected to each other despite having the same name. Some of the stations are very deep underground, and transfer times between certain metro lines can take a lot of time. In the city centre, it can save time to go directly to the above-ground entrance of the line you want to take rather than to enter at a connecting station and transfer underground. On the escalators, stand on the right and walk on the left except for peak hours, when standing on the left side is also allowed.

Some of the train stations include beautiful architecture and it is worth taking a guided tour of the metro system. The most interesting stations in terms of decor are **Komsomolskaya** (ring line), **Novoslobodskaya** (ring line), **Kievskaya** (ring line), **Kropotkinskaya** (Line #1 - red), **Kievskaya** (Line #3 - dark blue), **Arbatskaya** (Line #3 - dark blue), **Ploschad' Revolyutsii** (Line #3 - dark blue), **Mayakovskaya** (Line #2 - dark green). Also look at the architecture of the ground entrance building of **Arbatskaya** (Line #4 - light blue) and **Krasnye Vorota** (Line #1 - red). History buffs may appreciate that Metro Line #1 (red) has the oldest stations, opened in 1935.

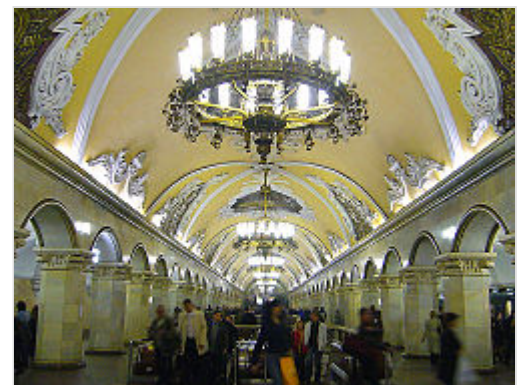
The **Vorobyovy Gory** Metro Station on Line #1 (red) is unique in that it is on a bridge crossing the Moscow River. This bridge also carries auto traffic road on another level. There is a beautiful view through the transparent sides of the station. A great observing point around Moscow is located nearby on Vorobyovy hills, next to the main building of Lomonosov Moscow State University.

There are a couple of unique trains operating through the system and you will be lucky if you get to ride them. *Aquarelle* (<https://www.mos.ru/en/news/item/22127073/>) (Watercolor) is a train that includes an art gallery. The train operates daily on Line #3 (dark blue). The *Sokolniki Retro Train* is a train modeled after the original 1930s trains and it occasionally is placed into service, usually around a major anniversary of the metro system.

The metro is relatively safe, although pickpockets are a problem, as they are in any environment where a lot of people are pressed together. Opportunistic petty crime, such as snatching someone's mobile phone and jumping out just as the doors are closing, is also commonplace. Take the usual precautions at night when gangs of inebriated teenagers may look for an excuse to



Moscow rail systems map 2023 with planned extensions up to 2026



The Metro in Moscow

beat someone up. There is no train guard or conductor, so the first car near the driver may be the safest. Every car is equipped with an intercom to the driver's cabin; they are beige boxes with a grill and a black button near doors, and mostly work, unless visibly vandalized.

### By Central Circle train

The Central Circle train operates on an old rail loop that lies between the Third Transport Ring and the Ring Road and was built in the beginning of the 20th century. It was then used for shuttling freight trains in and out of the city without having them clog the main stations. The comfortable Siemens Desiro trains (called "Lastochka" in Russia) provide service between 05:45 and 01:00, with 5-10 minute intervals. The entire circular journey takes an hour and a half. The Moscow Central Circle (МЦК -pronounced as *Em-Tse-Ka*) is integrated into the Moscow Metro, and is denoted by a pink hollow contour on the maps (<https://www.mos.ru/en/news/item/61866073/>), but there are few interchanges, with some of the stations marked as adjacent being as much as 15 minutes apart on foot. It is, however, useful for trips that avoid transfers in the center, and the trains are rarely packed. The same tickets as for Metro are valid, and where you need to transfer from one mode to the other (and correspondingly leave the system and enter through the barrier again), the Troika cards would recognize it and not charge you the second time. Unlike the Metro, it is allowed to carry bicycles on the Central Circle.

### By bus

Every large street in the city is served by at least one bus route. Most Moscow buses operate 05:30-01:00.

Numbers with an added 'к' or red sign ('к' for *короткий* — short) are shorter routes than their regular counterparts (for example bus 164 has a longer itinerary than 164к).

Numbers with an added 'м' (magistral routes; 'м' for *магистральный*) indicate more frequent routes, numbers with an added 'е' ('е' for *экспресс*, but uses cyrillic 'е' as there is the same letter 'e' in Latin alphabet) are express routes (which are subclass of magistral routes) and skip a lot of small stops.

Numbers with an added 'н' ('н' for *ночной* — night) indicate night services, few other routes also operate during the night.

Numbers with interval 901—908 are express buses, that skip many stops.

Main lines of buses are frequent until the late evening.

### By tram

There are several tram routes, although trams are not common in the city centre.



Validation of ticket



Mosgortrans bus in current blue transport livery on Spartakovskaya Street and Yelokhovo Cathedral on the foreground.





## By commuter rail

Local commuter trains (electrichkas) operate between the Moscow train stations and the suburbs of Moscow Oblast, but are of little use for seeing the tourist attractions. Schedules can be accessed online at the official operator site ([https://pass.rzd.ru/timetable/public/en?STRUCTURE\\_ID=735](https://pass.rzd.ru/timetable/public/en?STRUCTURE_ID=735)) and <https://rasp.yandex.ru/>.

Strelka and Troika cards are not valid for commuter trains, except if you have a multi-day commuter train ticket on your Troika card.

MCD (reads as *Em-Tse-De*) service of frequent trains - similar to Berlin's S-Bahn or Paris' RER - started on two lines, so some railway rides can be paid by Troika card. Single ticket costs 38.00₽ within the city limits and 45.00₽ within the closest outskirts.

## By taxi



**Note:** Beware of unofficial taxis that like to hang around tourist areas. They use a taxi meter; however, their meter goes by a fabricated inflated rate. A 10-minute ride can easily cost 3000.00₽ instead of 400.00₽. If not using a mobile app offering a fixed price, make sure to negotiate a fixed price before entering.

There are several taxi services operating in Moscow, the most noticeable on the streets being Yandex.Taxi; booked via the mobile app. Other popular hailing apps are Citimobil, Taxi Maxim, and Rutaxi - they all have English interfaces.

If you're not good in Russian, there are several English-speaking taxi services operating in Moscow, the most notable being LingoTaxi (<https://lingotaxi.com/moscow-fares/>). Prices are generally higher but booking by phone is easier.

## By car

Using a car in Moscow can be very time consuming and stressful. Moscow beyond the center is cut by railroads, industrial districts and rivers, so the road network is very irregular with tight bottlenecks between well-connected areas. The street system was never designed to accommodate even a fraction of today's vehicles and the traffic jams never seem to clear until the night. Evening jams lasting the entire night into the morning rush hours are rare but not unheard of. You will have to compete for the right-of-way with seasoned drivers who know the tangle of the streets inside out and will not think twice before cutting you off at the first



Bus on night route H5 on 01:26



Map of Moscow tram (2025)



opportunity. One bright spot is the dearth of the large 18-wheeler trucks on Moscow roads. Sometimes, all traffic on major thoroughfares may be blocked by police to allow government officials to blow through unimpeded, sirens blaring.

There is very little parking. Parking illegally can lead to a hefty fine of 2500.pyb and your car being towed. If you are driving to Moscow, park as soon as you can at a safe place such as your hotel and use public transit. Parking is usually not free and the costs can be found online (<http://parking.mos.ru/en/>). Expect to pay 80.pyb/hour for the parking within the Boulevard Ring and the district, 200.pyb/hour - between Boulevard Ring and Garden Ring, 40.pyb/hour between Garden Ring and Third Transport Ring. Payment is available through SMS (Russian SIM-cards only), mobile app or at parking columns. You have to pay for the full hour upfront, unused money will be sent back to your account. Like many other Russian cities, parking spaces, even parking lots, are disorganized, making safe parking a challenge.

However, if you have driven in New York City, Rome or Athens before, then it's not that hard to get accustomed to Moscow traffic. Just don't try to drive across the city during rush hours or you can be stuck for as long as 3 hours in traffic jams. Check one of the many traffic jam information websites before you start your journey. Check Yandex Maps before you start your journey. Taking the metro may actually be faster than driving.

Many or most local drivers consider official speed limits more of a guideline than anything. Driving up to 19 kilometres per hour (12 mph) above speed limit usually isn't punished (at least for locals), and in many places driving 30–40 kilometres per hour (19–25 mph) above speed limit is common in case of light traffic. The punishment system for bad driving is very lax. Some mobile apps give warning about automated cameras and they see wide use. Besides, some cars operate with speedometer broken. This is especially the case of microbus drivers operating on private suburban lines. Reckless driving is common, especially late at night on mostly empty streets. Drunk driving isn't uncommon, especially late at night. Paradoxically, rush hours are a lot safer to drive at, since traffic flow speed is naturally restricted.

Roads are almost empty during holidays at the beginning of January and May as well as during weekends and the summer. Friday evening in broad summer (roughly April to October) show great jams towards outside the city, while Sunday evening and Monday morning show great jams towards the city. Great jams can surround May and winter holidays.

**Gas stations:** BP, Lukoil, Gazpromneft, Rosneft gas stations all have good quality gasoline.

## By ship

Boats are not the best way to move around the city fast, but they do offer great scenery.

- **11 Stolichnaya Sudokhodnaya Kompania (Capital River Boat Tour Company).** depart about once hourly, every day. Several scenic routes geared for tourists] with prices in the range of 400-800.pyb. A pass is included in some hop-on-hop-off tours. 400-800.pyb.
- **12 Flotilla Radisson Royal** (<https://www.radisson-cruise.ru/>), Naberezhnaya Tarasa Shevchenko, 9, (Ukraine Hotel embankment) (*M: Krasnopresnenskaya*). Several year-round cruises. Unlike other tourist boats, these boats can move on ice very smoothly so that the waiter can easily pour champagne in crystal glasses on a table. There are huge panoramic windows to protect against the wind. The food is overpriced. The trips depart from either Hotel Ukraine or Gorky Park. 650-2,000.pyb.

## By bicycle

**Velobike** (<http://velobike.ru/>) operates a bike sharing network that has over 4,000 bicycles available at over 430 bike stations throughout city. To use it, you first have to register on the web site, mobile app or via terminal on bike station. Membership rates are 150.pyg per day, 500.pyg for a month, or 1,200.pyg for whole season. Usage fees, which are in addition to membership fees, vary, but the first 30 minutes are free. This is intentional to encourage people to use the system for short place-to-place trips; however, after riding for 30 minutes, you can dock your bike into a station, wait 2 minutes, and then take the bike out again to restart the timer. The service is only operational between April and November. After docking the bike you should get a text message confirmation. If you do not get a confirmation, you should call the company; otherwise, you may be fined.

## By hop-on-hop-off bus

**The hop-on-hop-off bus** (<https://city-sightseeing.ru/en/moscow>) is a convenient way for tourists to see the major sights quickly and efficiently. The buses feature English-speaking guides to answer any questions. A 1 day pass costs RUB3,400 for adults and RUB3,000 for children.

## See

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*Individual listings can be found in Moscow's district articles*

Moscow's architecture is world-renowned. Moscow is the site of *Saint Basil's Cathedral*, with its elegant onion domes, as well as the **Cathedral of Christ the Savior**. and the Seven Sisters. Look out for the monumental Stalinist architecture, most famously the **Seven Sisters**. Also check out a preserved collection of monumental buildings centred within the historic areas of the **Kremlin** and **Red Square**.

Moscow is a very green city: **Gorky Park** along the Moskva river contains estrades, children's attraction, dancing, tennis courts and other sports facilities.

Moscow has many notable art museums. The **Tretyakov Gallery** houses works in the classic Russian tradition and the works of Soviet artists. The **Pushkin Museum** of Fine Arts has a cross-section of exhibits on world civilisations, and paintings from every major Western era; works by Claude Monet, Paul Cézanne, and Pablo Picasso are present in the museum's collection. The **State Historical Museum** of Russia has exhibitions that range from relics of the prehistoric tribes inhabiting present-day Russia, through priceless artworks acquired by members of the Romanov dynasty.

## Do

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Moscow has many attractions, but many of them are not friendly to a non-Russian-speaker. ***The Moscow Times*** (<https://www.themoscowtimes.com/>) is an English-language newspaper help to navigate towards English-language friendly attractions and services; however, it may be hard to access due to its political stance.

Make sure you visit a **Russian bathhouse** (*banya*) while in Moscow, as it's an important Russian tradition and some Russians, especially those over 40 years old, go at least once a week. Have a hot steam, followed by a good whipping with birch branches. While it's not the most pleasant experience, the benefits you'll receive afterward will enable you to understand why Russians are loyal to their banya.

The **Great Moscow State Circus** in Moscow's outskirts has 5 arenas (equestrian, water, illusionist, ice rink, and light-effect) 18 m below the floor. **Moscow Nikulin Circus** is in Moscow/Central-North.

The **Bolshoi Theatre** in Moscow/Central-North is one of the most famous in the world, in the center of the city. Includes ballet, opera, and classical music performances.

The **Sun of Moscow** in Moscow's outskirts is Europe's tallest Ferris wheel (140 m height). The **Moscow Zoo**, also in Moscow's outskirts, is the oldest zoo, dating to 1864, and the biggest zoo in Russia, has over 6,000 animals representing about 1000 species and covers an area of about 21.5 hectares.

You can go **ice skating** in Moscow's outskirts at the Gorky Central Park of Culture and Leisure, and Luzhniki aka Kristall skating ring.

Moscow has four **football** teams playing in the Premier League, the top tier of Russian football. Russian football clubs were suspended from FIFA and UEFA competitions due to the 2022 Russian invasion of Ukraine. This ban has been extended to the 2025-26 season. All four play in stadiums in Moscow's outskirts.

## Learn

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Moscow remains the educational center of Russia and the former USSR. There are 222 institutes of higher education, including 60 state universities & 90 colleges. Some of these offer a wide-spectrum of programs, but most are centered around a specific field. This is a hold-over from the days of the USSR, when Sovietwide there were only a handful of wide-spectrum "universities" and a large number of narrow-specialization "institutes" (mostly in Moscow & St.Petersburg). Moscow offers some of the best business/management, science, & arts schools in the world. Moscow is also a popular destination for foreign students to learn Russian.



Moscow State University



See Studying in Russia for a list of universities in Moscow.

## Work

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You will need a work visa which is not an easy process. The visa needs to be arranged well in advance of traveling. It is possible to work in Moscow, you just need to find a good company to support you. The main obstacle for many foreigners will be a mandatory Russian language exam required to obtain a work permit.



## Buy

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Currency exchange offices are plentiful in the city, but be sure to count your change and note that the advertised rates sometimes don't include an added commission or only apply to large exchanges. Be sure to break your 5,000 pyb and 1,000 pyb notes where you can since the smaller merchants, street vendors and even many metro clerks often refuse them.

Large shopping malls are common near metro stations.

## Eat

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Dining establishments in Moscow range from food stalls near metro stations to quick canteen-style 'Stolovaya' eateries to American-style fast food chains to overpriced restaurants catering to tourists to high-end restaurants where you can spend 10,000 pyb.

Restaurants and cafes promising "European and Caucasus cuisine" generally cater to tourists and are usually bad; seek a restaurant that specializes in a single region instead (Georgian, Russian, Italian, French, etc.).

Many small restaurants offer lunch specials costing 200-250 pyb. These deals are valid from 12:00 to 15:00 and include a cup of soup or an appetizer, a small portion of the main dish of the day, bread and a non-alcoholic beverage.

For information on **tipping** in restaurants, see [Russia#Eat](#).

Authentic **ethnic food** from countries of the nearby [Caucasus](#) ([Azerbaijan](#), [Georgia](#), [Armenia](#)) is common in Moscow. Japanese food, including sushi, rolls, tempura, and steakhouses are very popular in Moscow. Other Asian cuisines including Vietnamese, Thai, and Chinese are becoming increasingly more common.

## Budget

### Street food

Free-standing kiosks serving sausages, meat pies, or kebobs are plentiful, although the origins of the meat served is questionable and the food has been known to occasionally make people sick.

Muscovites are also fond of their ice cream, consumed in any weather, even in the dead of winter, cheap and usually of superior quality; kiosks can be found all over the center and near all Metro stations.



Russian borsch



## Fast food chains

- **Burger King** (<https://burgerkingrus.ru/>) and **Rostics** (<https://rostics.ru/>) have locations near almost every shopping mall. It is common to pay extra for condiments.
- **Black Star Burger** (<https://blackstarburger.ru/>) - Restaurant chain specializing in burgers with locations throughout Russia.
- **Kroshka-Kartoshka** (<http://www.kartoshka.com/>) – These green kiosks sell microwave-baked potatoes as well as toasted sandwiches and a few drinks. Hot and filling, but rather expensive for a potato.
- **Riksha Ivan** ("Ivan the Rickshaw") – Quick Chinese-like cuisine; fried rice with meat to go.
- **Teremok** (<https://teremok.ru/>) – This chain started as a fast-food specialized on blinchiki, Russian crepes that come with a variety of fillings, with somewhat national old-fashion touch towards style and cuisine. Teremok is one of the cheapest chains offering a proper quality 3-course meals, including a soup, a main dish with a salad and a dessert. The drinks are overpriced, but not unreasonably so.
- **Kruzhka** (<https://xn--80aaahi2bjaklrrng.xn--p1ai/kruzhka>) – Serves cheap food and mugs of beer. 20 locations around Moscow. The menu is relatively simple, consisting mainly of types of kebab and shawarma, with fries. Sports events are often shown on televisions or a big screen.
- **Prime Star** (<https://www.prime-star.ru/>) – Specializing in natural food such as sandwiches and salads. 400 руб for a cold soup, salad, and beverage.
- **Dodo Pizza** (<https://dodopizza.ru/>) - Chain restaurant specializing in pizza and pasta with locations throughout Russia. They also offer delivery.

## Canteen-style cafeterias

Known as *столовая* (*stolovaya*) in Russian, in these establishments, you take a tray, move along a counter with food (either taking the dishes yourself or asking the staff to give you a bowl of soup, a plate of vegetables, etc.) and pay at the cash register at the end of the counter. These self-serve establishments trace their origin to Soviet times, and have decent quality food, no waiting time, and affordable prices. Canteen chains include Café Moo-Moo (<https://www.cafemumu.ru/>) (30 locations) and Grabli (Грабли) (<https://grably.ru/>). One particularly famous one in Moscow is Stolovaya 57 in the famous GUM department store.

## Food courts 2.0

This term is used in articles by local food critics: since 2016, several special food courts were opened in Moscow's outskirts with independent and small food chains, for those people who get bored of McDonald's-like food. They offer a wider choice of cuisines.

## Mid-range

VietCafe (<http://vietcafe.com/#!/ru/moscow>) is a popular chain of Vietnamese restaurants that has several locations.

## Splurge

## Drink

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*Individual listings can be found in Moscow's district articles*

## Clubs

Nightlife in Moscow is bustling, intense and exciting. It starts quite late; it's common for the headliners to start at 02:00-02:00. Most noticeable are areas near Solyanka street and Krasniy Oktyabr' place. At summer time a lot of clubs opening open-air terraces called "verandas". Most of clubs in Moscow are very picky of who they let in, so make sure you have a positive attitude and dress up if you are going to a fancy club.

## Cafes

Moscow has several café chains with great coffee including Coffeemia (https://coffeemia.ru/) and Coffee Bean (https://coffeebean.ru/). Moscow also has a good selection of tea saloons. High-quality infusion teas such as Newby, are widely available in cafes, both in packets and loose.

Asking to add boiling water to the tea you ordered earlier is a practice that some cafes don't welcome, but normally it's acceptable.

## Sleep

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*Individual listings can be found in Moscow's district articles*

## Stay safe

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Moscow enjoys a relatively low crime rate.

Drunk people are the most likely sources of problems. In the past years, lots of policemen were corrupt, and it was best to avoid them. Nowadays Moscow has a Tourist Police force, whose officers are able to speak foreign languages and help tourists. Police officers are equipped with body-cameras.

It is preferable to avoid some parts of the outer districts of Moscow, especially in the south. Some of those areas are notorious for gopniks (drunkards notorious for muggings and starting fights with strangers, and will do so seemingly unprovoked), who normally hang out in sparse residential areas and in industrial zones. The same problems can be witnessed in the surrounding regions and in other Russian cities as well.



Patrol Police vehicle



While traveling in Moscow, as in the rest of Russia, you should always have your passport with you. If you look non-white, your papers may get checked more often than otherwise. The police may demand to see your papers to check if you have been registered within 7 business days of your arrival into Moscow. Always remember that if you stay in a hotel then you are automatically registered and will be handed a confirmation paper at a time of check-in, so don't worry in this case. The police are usually looking for migrants from Central Asia and unless you fit this profile, you are unlikely to be questioned.

Women should take caution walking alone late at night since they may receive unwanted attention from drunk men. Women should also stay clear of large companies of men in front of bars, restaurants, etc. It is best to walk with a friend if possible.

Streets can become very slippery in winter. Wear shoes or, even better, boots with decent grip to prevent twisted ankles. Ice patches can be hard to spot. A waterproof raincoat is also sensible.

Traffic is poorly handled, and vehicle accident rates are very high.

If you need help with translation, ask students or pupils: younger people are more likely to be able to help you than the older generations.

## Connect

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For information on using telephones and buying SIM cards in Russia, see [Russia#Connect](#).

Mobile Internet is quite affordable in Russia, but you have to buy Russian SIM-card first.

### Wireless Internet

Moscow Metro has Wi-Fi in all trains. It is ad-supported.

Mosgortrans has Wi-Fi spots on every bus, trolleybus and tram. Also sometimes you can find Wi-Fi spot on a public transport stop.

Beeline Wi-Fi (<https://moskva.beeline.ru/customers/pomosh/mobile/beeline-wifi/>) operates the largest network of both paid and free Wi-Fi access points.

There is a large network of free Wi-Fi hotspots in the city centre; check your device in the middle of a busy area and you may find one.

Many cafes and restaurants offer Wi-Fi - ask for password. Most bookstores offer free Wi-Fi, including "Dom Knigi" on New Arbat Street or "Respublika" bookstore on Tverskaya near Mayakovskaya Metro Station.

Some establishments that offer free Wi-Fi may require you to verify an authorization code sent to a Russian phone number before gaining access.

## Cope

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### Embassies

Moscow is one of the global diplomatic hubs, competing with [Berlin](#), [Brussels](#), [Beijing](#), [Paris](#), [London](#), [Tokyo](#) and [Washington D.C.](#). Most of the world's countries have embassies in the city.

|                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------|
| Diplomatic missions[ <a href="#">Expand</a> ] |
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## Go next

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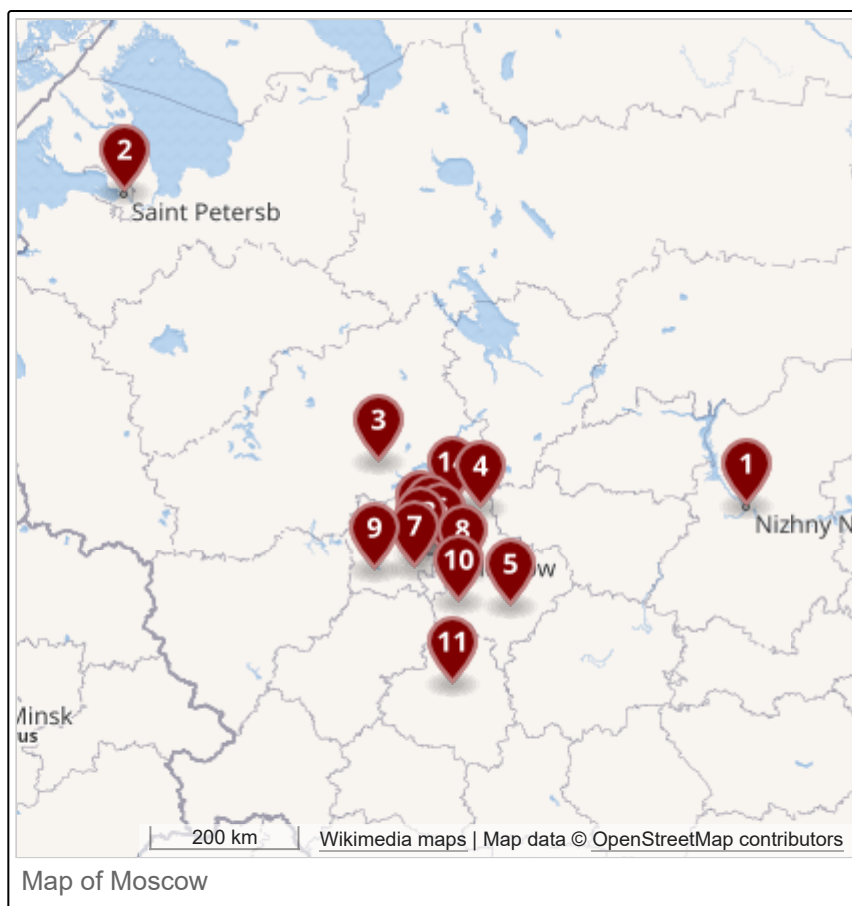
Moscow is a hub for flights and trains in Russia.

### Day trips

- **The Central Air Force Museum** in Monino is about 40 km east of the Yaroslavy Railway Station. Take the Metro to Komsomolskaya station. Buy a ticket for the local train service at the ticket booth outside the main ticket building. Look for the windows that have hand-written signs with timetables (in Russian). There is service every 20-30 minutes, except for the middle of the day (1½ hour gap). There are local and express trains that take about 1 hr 15 min to get to Monino. There are several dozen aircraft outside in various states of repair. Some planes are fairly neglected. There is a large indoor hangar with many World War II aircraft and displays.
- **Main Cathedral of the Russian Armed Forces** - A lavish structure with militaristic murals near the town of Kubinka in West Moscow Oblast.
- **Vladimir and Suzdal** - **Vladimir** is most famous for its three 12th century monuments : the five-domed Assumption Cathedral with magnificent frescoes of Andrey Rublev, the warrior-like cathedral of St. Demetrius notable for its unique carvings and the Golden Gate, which used to be a tower over the city's main gate. **Suzdal** is very quiet for there are no train stations or industries. Highlights include the Assumption cathedral interior (it is open), St Demetrius cathedral (outside), Golden Gates (outside), the Museum of Wooden Architecture, St Euthimius monastery, Suzdal Kremlin and trading square where you can buy something from locals. Driving back to Vladimir to take 17:59 train back to Moscow which arrives at 19:40.
- **Yaroslavl** - Yaroslavl is a picturesque town on the Volga River, famous for its beautiful 17th-century churches, parks and gardens, luxury merchants' mansions and the oldest drama theatre of Russia.
- **Bogdarnya** - You can drive there for 3 hours. Besides rural views with the winding Klyazma river and vast meadows you might enjoy numerous countryside activities like horse-riding, fishing, mushroom and berries picking (in summer), cheese or meat master classes.
- **Bogolyubovo** - Bogolyubovo is famous for the ancient Pokrova-on-the-Nerl Church of the 12th century on the Nerl river among picturesque meadows. It is a 15-minute walk to the church.
- **Kostroma** - You can go by car. The town is located at the confluence of the Volga and the Kostroma Rivers. Visit the Ipatiev Monastery, once the shelter of Mikhail Romanov, the first tsar of the Romanov Dynasty. The Trinity Cathedral is known for its frescos. The central part of Kostroma is admired for the 18th-century architecture of provincial town.
- **Pereslavl Zalesky** - Drive to Pereslavl Zalesky, the town known since the 12th century. Sightseeing of Red Square and the ramparts This town is famous for some unique museums like Museum of Iron, Museum of Kettle, Botik Museum ( This museum contains the only surviving boat from Peter the Great amusement flotilla)
- **Rostov Veliky** - To do and see: Kremlin of Rostov Veliky, a walk along Nero lake, Rostov enamel exhibition, stunning panoramic views from the top of the bell tower, the exhibition of Finift (painted enamel). There is a 07:35 train.
- **Yuryev-Polskoy** - Drive to Yuryev-Polskoy, the town founded in the 12 century by Yuri Dolgoruky (founder of Moscow). The chief landmark of the town is St. George Church, brilliant example of pre-Mongolian architecture. Also visit the grounds of the walled Archangel Michael Monastery, and enjoy picturesque views from the bell tower.
- **Serpukhov** — an old city to the south of Moscow, which has its own kremlin, Vysotsky Monastery, and Vladychny Convent

## Further out

- **Golden Ring** — Old cities and towns rich in historical buildings in the heartland of Muskovy Russia. There are many tourist companies organizing guided tours, but travellers with rudimentary knowledge of Cyrillic alphabet can do it independently. Many guidebooks are available in English.
- **1 Nizhny Novgorod** — the so-called "younger brother of Moscow." You can get there from Moscow only 3½ hours by train *Lastochka* or *Strizh*.
- **2 Saint Petersburg** — 13 overnight trains leave Moscow for the 7-hour (or thereabouts) journey, arriving the next morning.
- **3 Tver** — Known as "Tiny Petersburg" thanks to its city structure.
- **4 Sergiev Posad** – A picturesque town 75 km to the northeast of Moscow that is famous for the 14th century Trinity Monastery of St. Sergius, one of the most important centers of the Orthodox religion and a major destination of pilgrims. The only town of the Golden Ring near Moscow.
- **5 Kolomna** – 2-3 hr (by rail) southeast of Moscow is a nice medieval town with very interesting churches and monasteries
- **6 Arkhangelskoye Palace** (<http://www.arhangelskoe.su/>) (Архангельское), Krasnogorsk (*Metro stations: "Tushinskaya"*). One of the finest of Moscow Oblast's usadbas (estates) is only a short elektrichka ride away from Moscow and makes a fine day excursion.
- **7 Kubinka Tank Museum** (<http://www.tankmuseum.ru/>) (Бронетанковый музей в Кубинке) (67 km (42 mi) W of Moscow centre), ☎ +7 800 707-01-07. Tu-Su 10:00-17:00. One of the finest armour collections in the world. About one hour west of the city. Access is restricted.
- **8 Leninskiye Gorki** (<http://www.russianmuseums.info/M446>) (Гórки Лéнинские) (10 km (6.2 mi) south of Moscow city limits), ☎ +7 495 548-9309, gorki-len@yandex.ru (mailto:gorki-len@yandex.ru). An old country estate, expropriated by the Communist authorities after 1917 and used by V. Lenin as his country residence when he became ill. Large museum, although pretty decrepit now.
- **9 State Borodino War and History Museum and Reserve** (<http://www.borodino.ru/>) (Государственный Бородинский военно-исторический музей-заповедник «Бородинское поле») (By suburban train: from the Belarusian railway station to "Borodino" or "Mozhaysk" station (2-3 a day, 2 hr) or intercity bus № 457 to Mozhaysk further - by bus to the "Borodino" museum). Group visits only, by appointment. This is the site of the famous Battle of Borodino. Museum and national historic site.
- **10 Melikhovo** (Мéлихово) (65 km (40 mi) south of Moscow). Chekhov's country house



- **11 Yasnaya Polyana** (<http://ypmuseum.ru/>) (Ясная Поляна) (12 km (7.5 mi) SW of Tula and 200 km (120 mi) S from Moscow.). Tolstoi's country house
- **12 New Jerusalem Resurrection Monastery** – in Istra, between Novoierusalimskaya (15 min on foot) and Istra (15 min by bus) elektrichka stations, around 60 km (37 mi) from Moscow. Trains to Istra, from Moscow's Rizhsky Vokzal (Riga Station) (~20 a day, 1½ hr) (2011). A monastery-fortress (male, working) with a number of museums inside and next to the walls: wooden architecture museum, local history museum, art and history museum, etc.
- **13 Savvino-Storozhevskiy monastery** (<http://www.savvastor.ru/>) (Саввино-Сторожевский монастырь) (65 km (40 mi) W; Commuter trains from Belorussky station to Zvenigorod, several daily; travel time ~1 hr, 1.5 km (0.93 mi) west to monastery, which is on a nearby hill.). A beautiful monastery with interesting history, closely connected to Russian Tzars.
- **14 Dmitrov** (Дмитров) (65 km (40 mi) North from Moscow (trains from Savelovsky station, several daily, 1½ hr)). A town, on Moscow Channel, with old churches, interesting sculptures in the streets and a number of museums
- **15 Snegiri** (40 km (25 mi) NW from Moscow (Volokolamskoe hwy), trains from Rizhsky Station, several daily, travel time about an hour). A settlement that boasts a monument to the Defense of Moscow during World War II, with a good collection of tanks, and a museum.

#### Routes through Moscow

